Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence in the Arts and Music: A Take on Opportunities and Risks

These slides are live at:
https://kivanctatar.com/2026-10-uniarts-ai/

Kıvanç Tatar, Associate Professor in Interactive AI
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Upcoming, from December 2026

Professor in Digital Art with emphasis on AI and Co-Creativity

Kıvanç Tatar, Associate Professor in Interactive AI

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Acknowledgements

Country	Funding Body	Timeline
Finland	Foundation PostScriptum , ELLIS Insitute Finland, and UniArts Helsinki	2026-
Sweden	VR - Vetenskapsrådet	2025-2031
Sweden	The Wallenberg AI, Autonomous Systems, and Software Program – Humanities and Society	2021-2030
Canada	Canada Council for the Arts	2018-2022
Canada	BC Arts Council	2020
Switzerland	Swiss National Science Foundation	2020-2021
Canada	Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council	2014-2020
Canada	Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council	2014-2019

What does Artificial Intelligence technology encapsulate?

-Multimodal Foundation Models

-Large Language Models and Agentic AI (GPT, DeepSeek etc.)

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-Multi-agent Systems

-Artificial Life

-Evolutionary Algorithms (Genetic Algorithms, Genetic Programming, etc.)

-Symbolic AI, Expert Systems, Rule-based Systems, etc.

Calculating Empires (Crawford and Joler 2023)

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https://calculatingempires.net/?pos=64626.91%2C13950.71%2C14.3640

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Multi-agent Systems

- -Realtime and interactive
- -The agency in performance can be distributed to humans and autonomous systems
- -The aesthetics are flexible when the agents can be trained on a dataset

+ Conventional Machine Learning

- -Self-Organising Maps
- -Variable Markov Models or Factor Oracle

A Conversation with Artificial Intelligence (2017)

```
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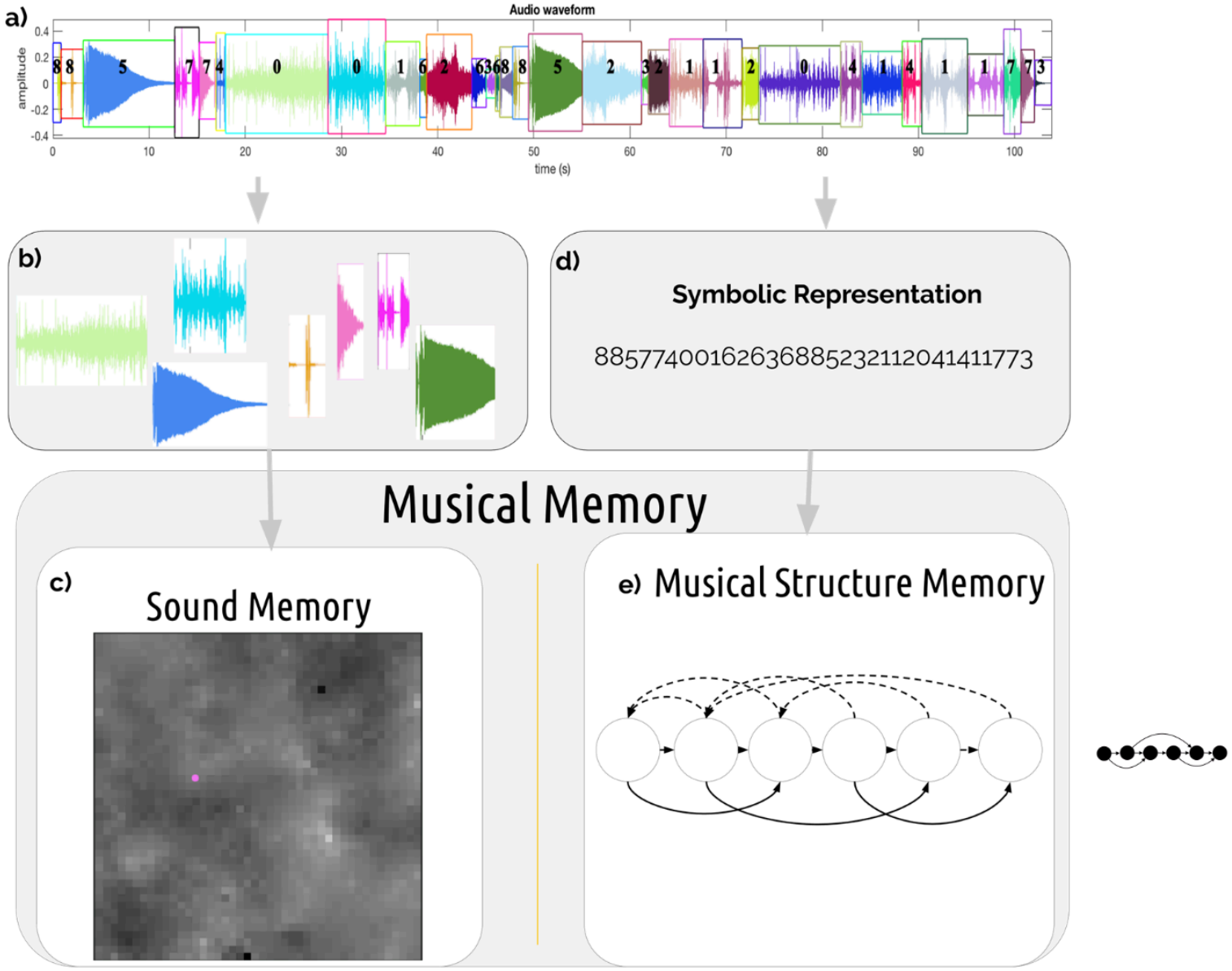
Musical Agents based on Self-Organizing Maps (MASOM)

K. Tatar, “Musical agents based on self-organizing maps for audio applications,” Thesis, Communication, Art & Technology: School of Interactive Arts and Technology, 2019. Available: http://summit.sfu.ca/item/19665

Training a MASOM model



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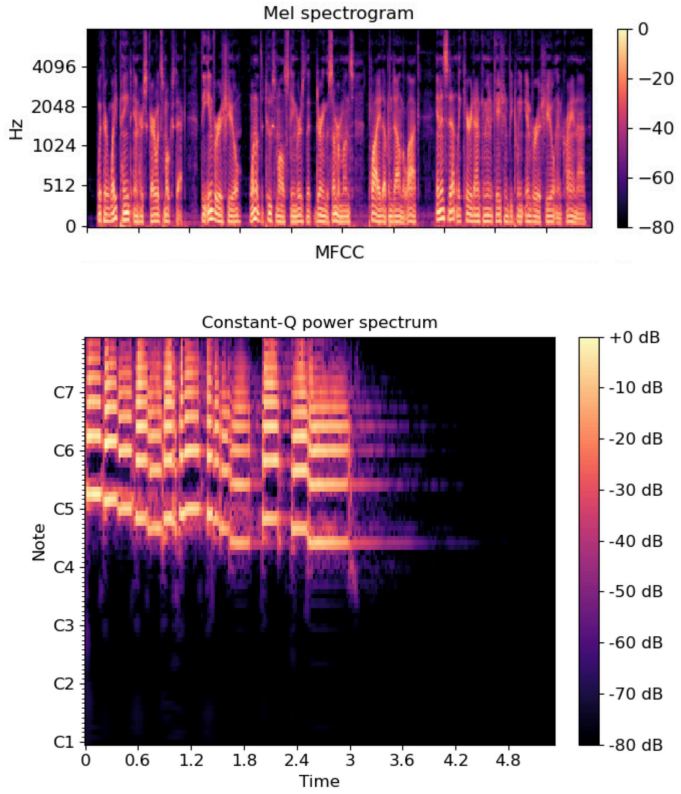
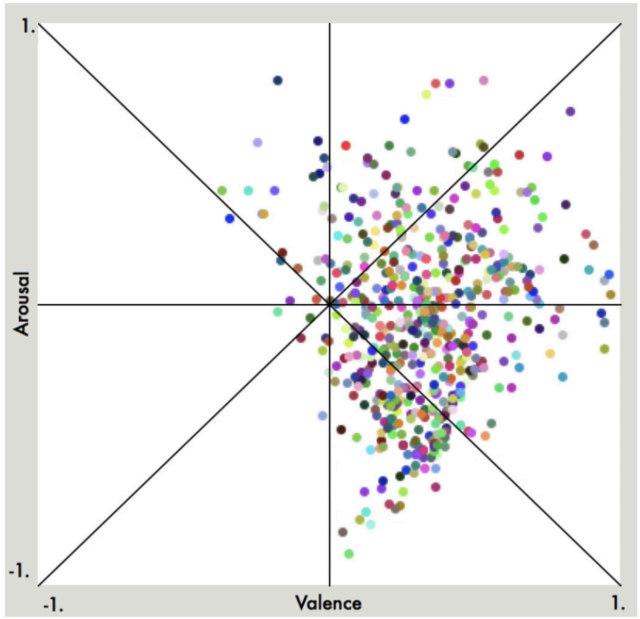
Feature extraction examples

Spectral Features



Higher level features



Each dot represents a novel segment of Stockhausen's Kontakte. Each segment is labeled using the dimensional affect estimation model of MASOM.

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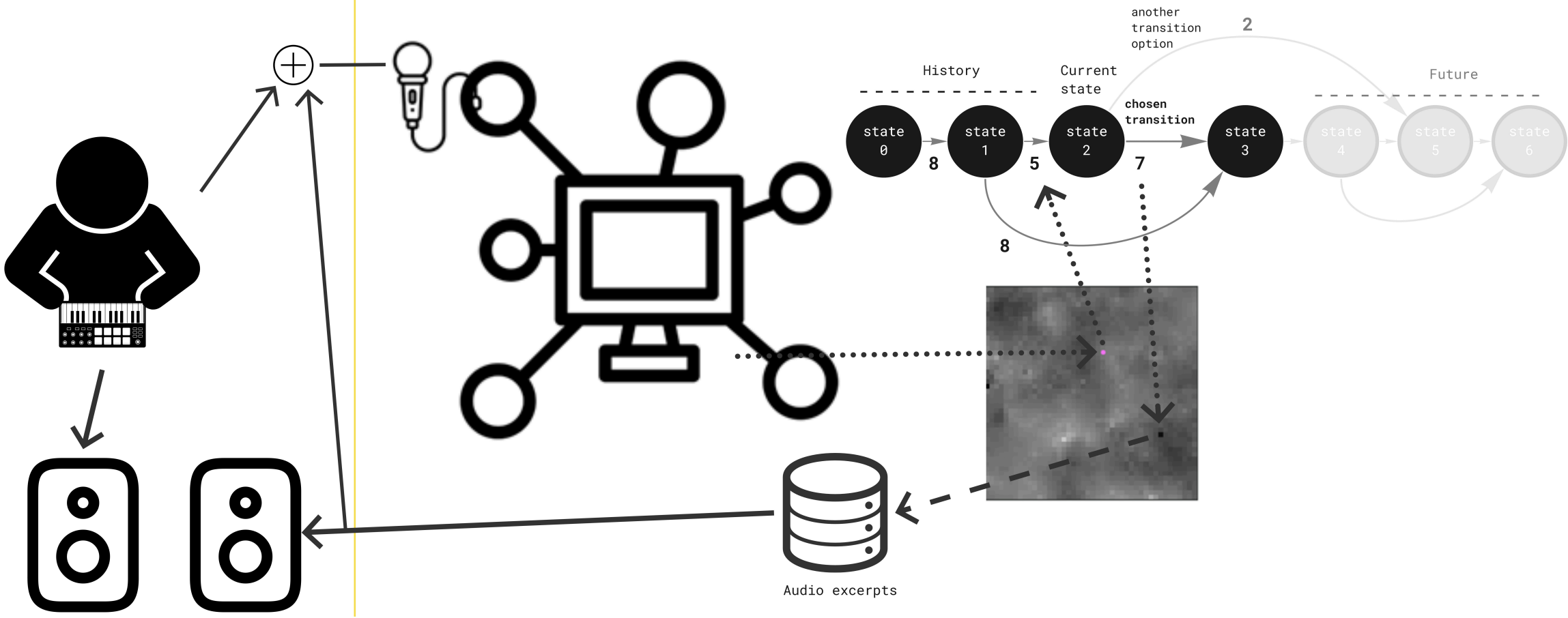
Co-Performance with MASOM



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Organizing Sounds with Artificial Intelligence

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A Big MASOM Family

```
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Plastic Biosphere (2020-2021)

highlights the imperative coexistence of humankind and the material, plastics.

In the anthropocene era, humankind created over 300 million tons of plastic every year, and this production has become a geophysical force of nature. The ubiquitous material extends beyond our reach and control, creating its own life-cycles, existing as an unignorable element of the biosphere.

AI models used

-Style imitation based on the repo *neural-style-tf*, which builds on

  -L. A. Gatys, A. S. Ecker, and M. Bethge, “Image Style Transfer Using Convolutional Neural Networks,” in Proceedings of the IEEE Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), Jun. 2016.

  -M. Ruder, A. Dosovitskiy, and T. Brox, “Artistic style transfer for videos,” 2016. doi: 10.1007/978-3-319-45886-1_3.

  -L. A. Gatys, M. Bethge, A. Hertzmann, and E. Shechtman, “Preserving Color in Neural Artistic Style Transfer,” Jun. 19, 2016, arXiv: arXiv:1606.05897. doi: 10.48550/arXiv.1606.05897.

-Musical AI by musical agents based on self-organizing maps

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Plastic Biosphere No.1

```
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```

Plastic Biosphere No.1 at Kepler's Gardens

Plastic Biosphere No.1 - Credits

Author	Role
Kıvanç Tatar	Artist, Creative AI developer
Grigore Burloiu	Technical Director
Marius Hodea	3D Modelling
Iuliana Gherghescu	Set Design
Andrei Gindac	Admin
Assoc. Prof. Alexandru Berceanu	CINETic Director

Plastic Biosphere No.2 - Credits

Author	Role
Kıvanç Tatar	Artistic Director / Creative AI development
Tamar Tabori	Contemporary Dance
Dan O'Shea	Technical Director
Remy Siu	Technical Consultant

Plastic Biosphere No.2

```
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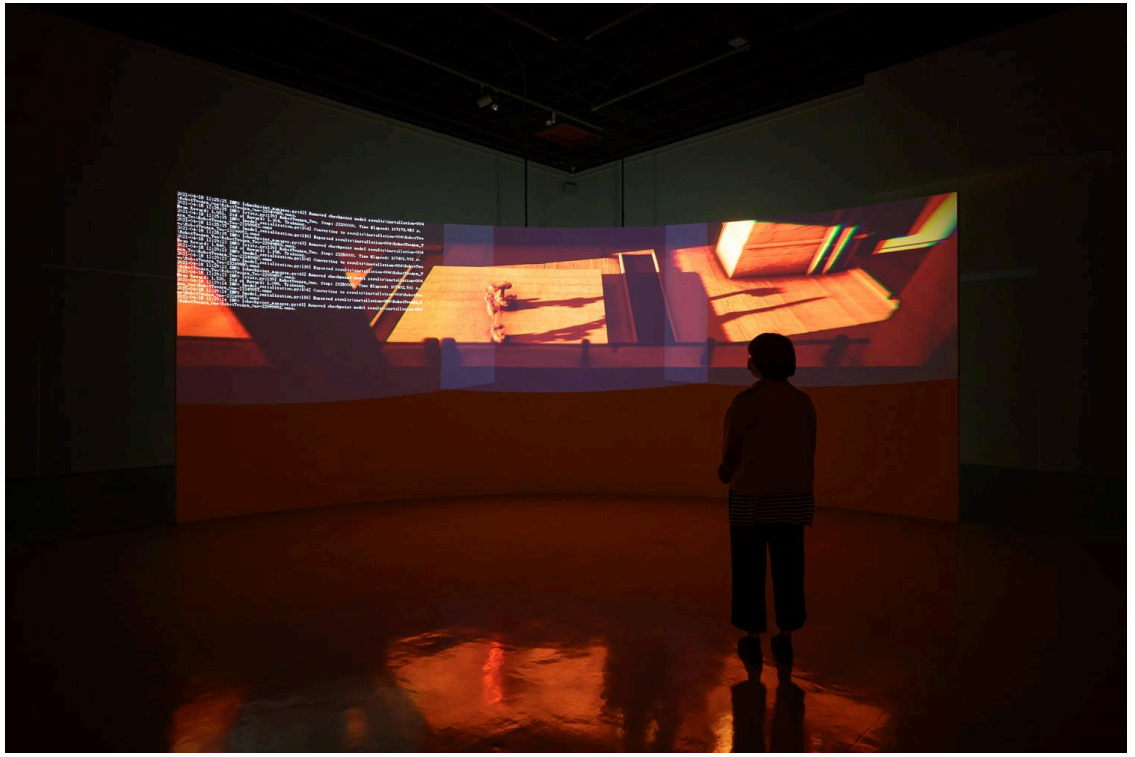
Gestalt Generation No.1 (2021)

Two robotic arms controlled by reinforcement learning agents learning intimacy and borders,

by Remy Siu and Kıvanç Tatar



Gestalt Generation No.1 - Research Process

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Deep Generative Modelling for Organized Sound

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Artistic Technology Research - What if?

What if I could synthesize sounds in between existing sounds?

Latent Timbre Synthesis (2020)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-1XuXbX_VZo

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```

Latent Timbre Synthesis

K. Tatar, D. Bisig, and P. Pasquier, “Latent Timbre Synthesis,” Neural Computing & Applications, Oct. 2020, doi: 10.1007/s00521-020-05424-2.

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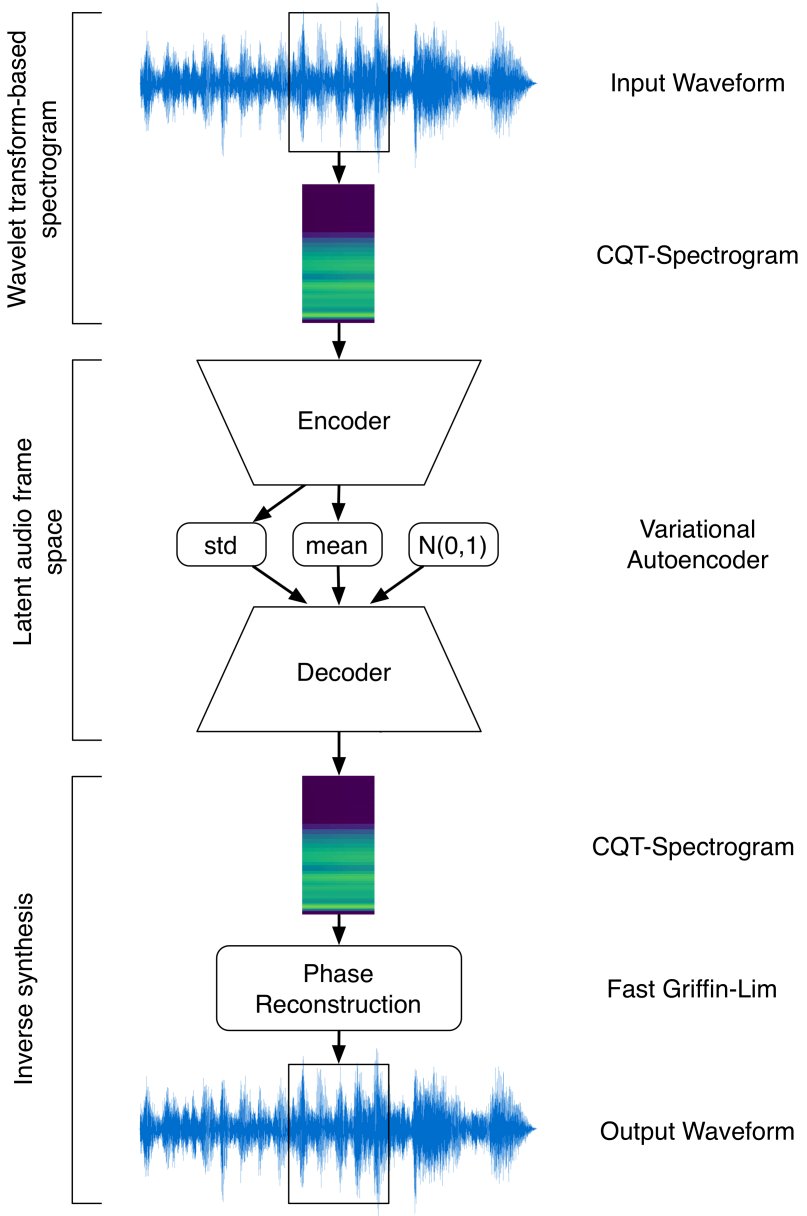
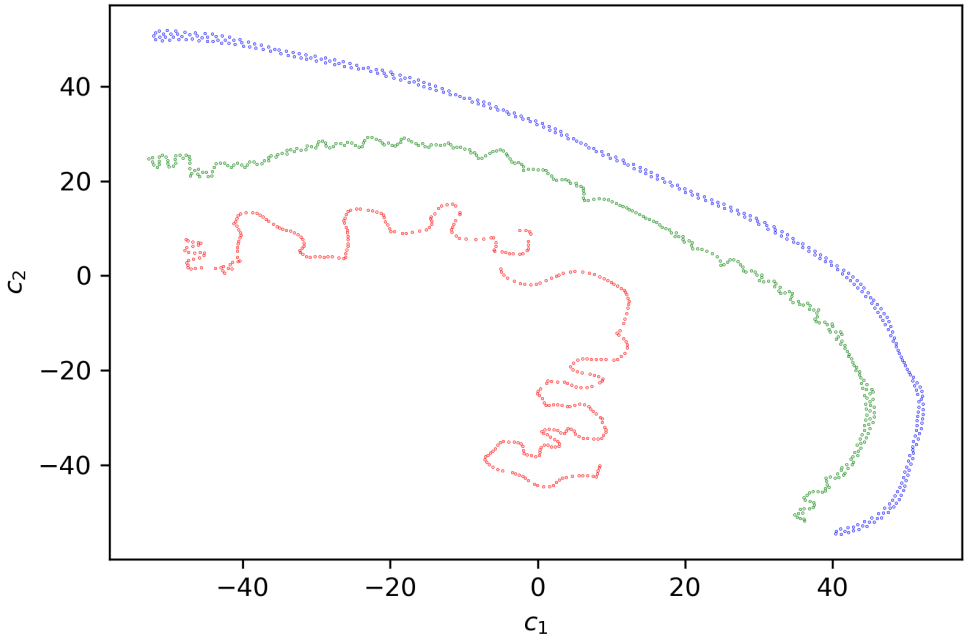
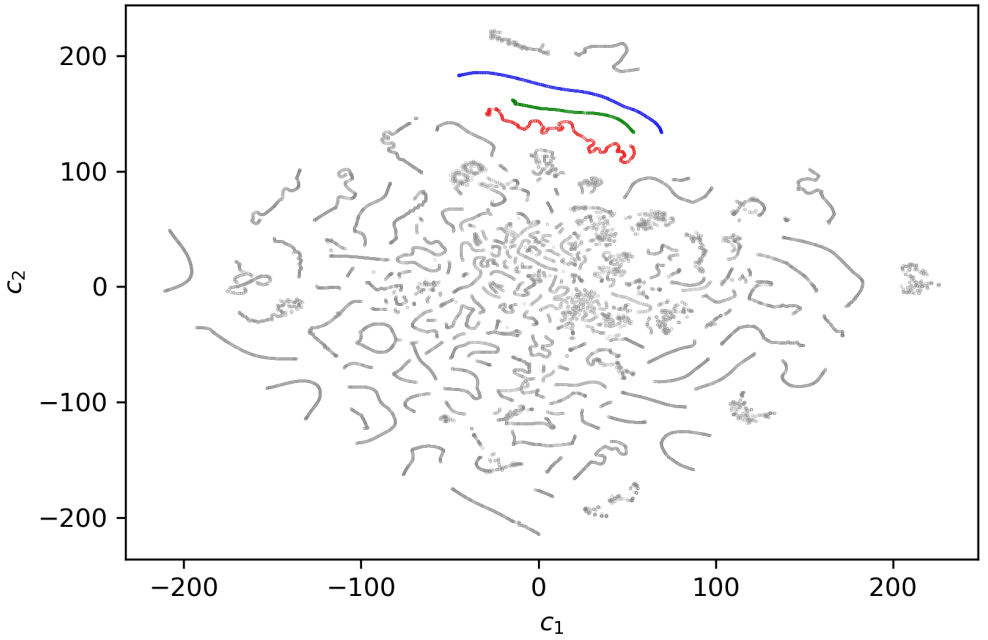


Latent Timbre Synthesis

Interpolations in the latent space of the VAE





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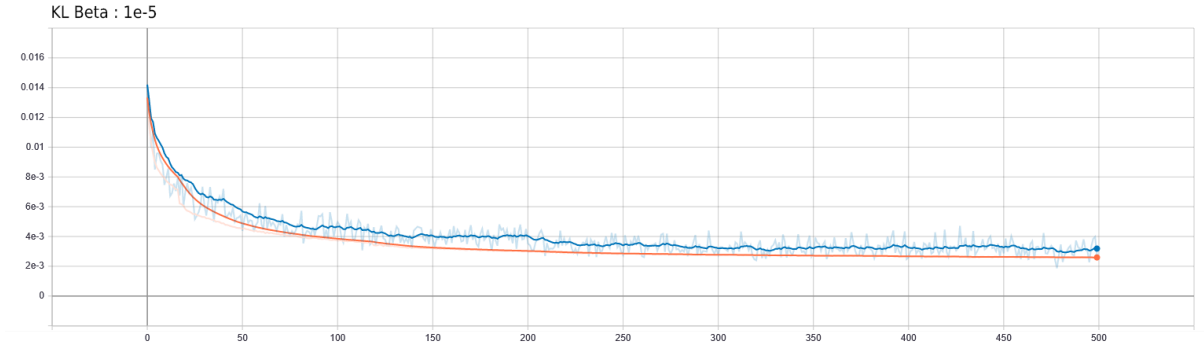
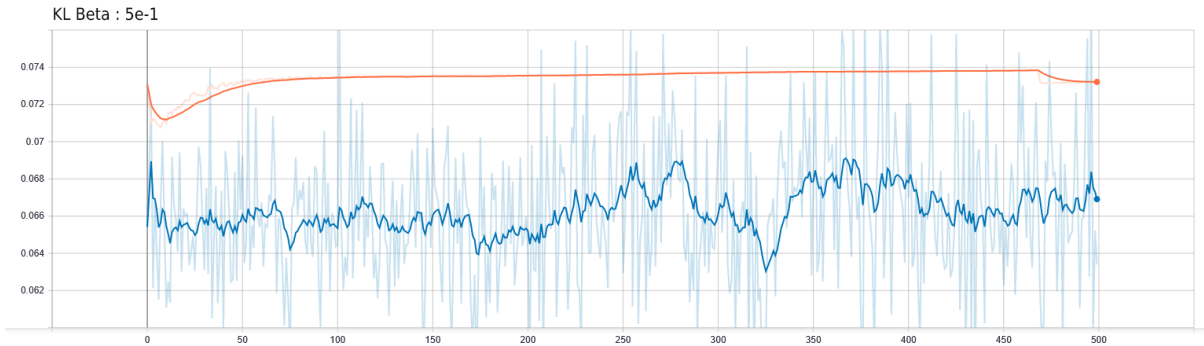
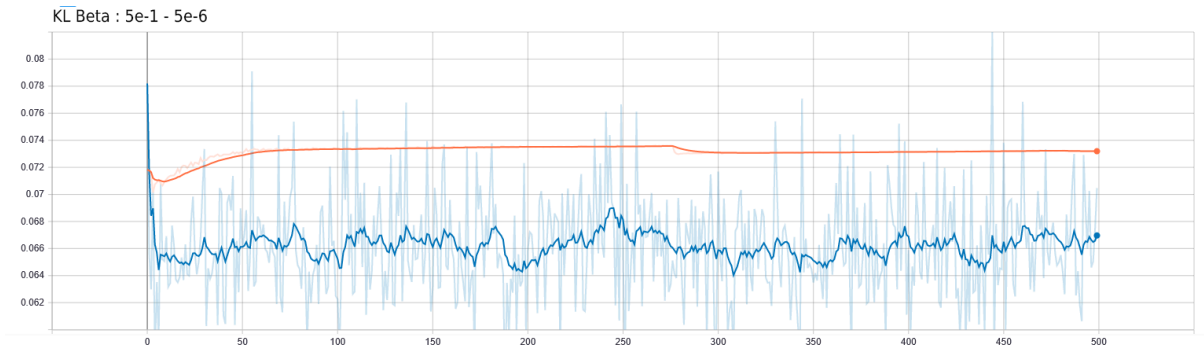
Deep Generative Modelling is not neutral.

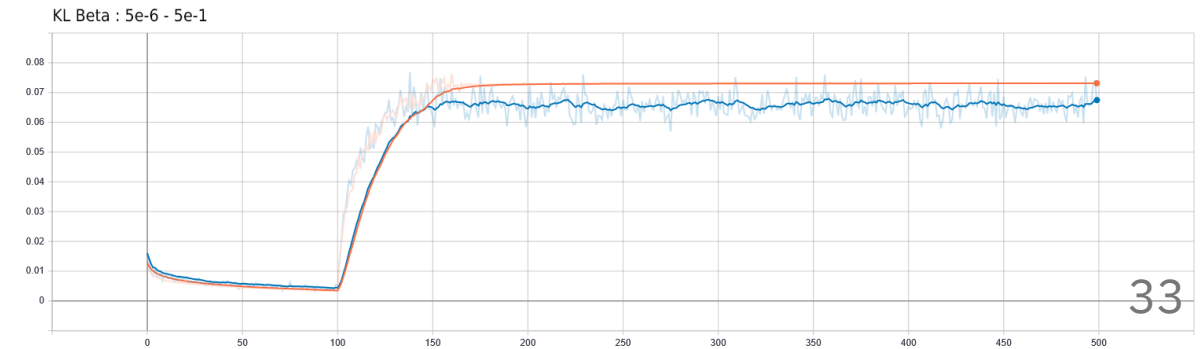
Latent Timbre Synthesis

Notes on Reproducibility









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Latent Timbre Synthesis

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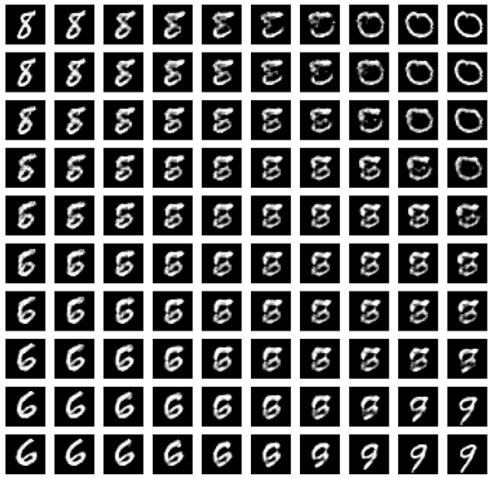
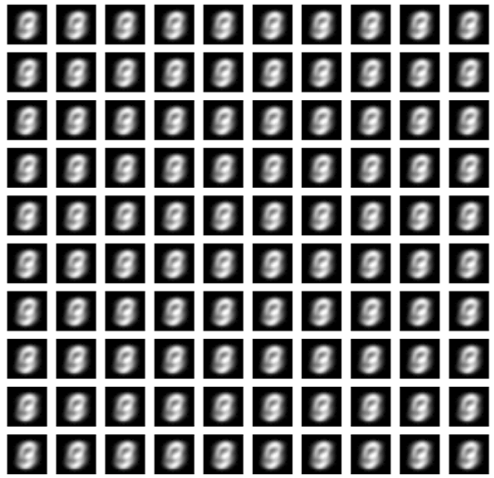
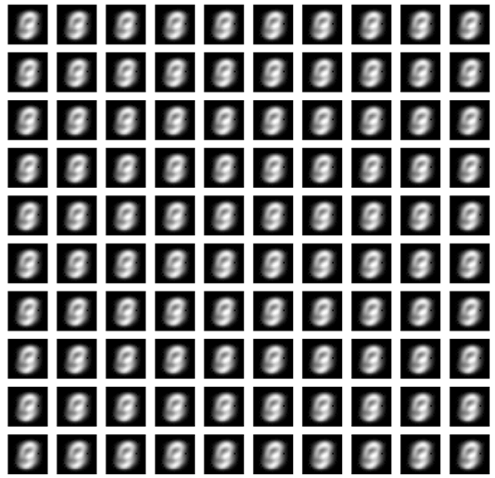
KL Beta : 1e-5



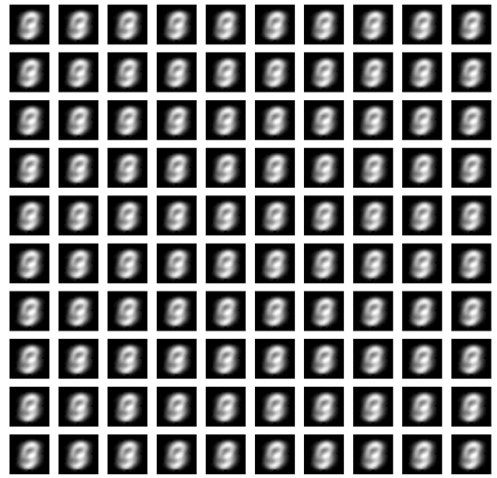
KL Beta : 5e-1



KL Beta : 5e-1 - 5e-6



KL Beta : 5e-6 - 5e-1



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Most Musical AI research are ad-hoc efforts.

Latent Timbre Synthesis

Emerging themes from the user study with 9 composers:

- -Iterative sound design in musical composition
- -Musical strategies
- -Musical goals and concepts
- -Familiarity
- -Affordances
- -Sound aesthetics
- -Sound quality
- -User Inteface
- -Tool Deficiencies
- -Continued use

Open Questions

-How to showcase aesthetics of different models?

  -Challenge: It is impossible to hear all possibilities of a model through human listening, hence other approaches needed.

-What are emergent research threads that we could share and compare across works?

How do we make music with vast sound search spaces?

Coding the Latent Artwork (2022)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rfq82eKE-34&t=2810s

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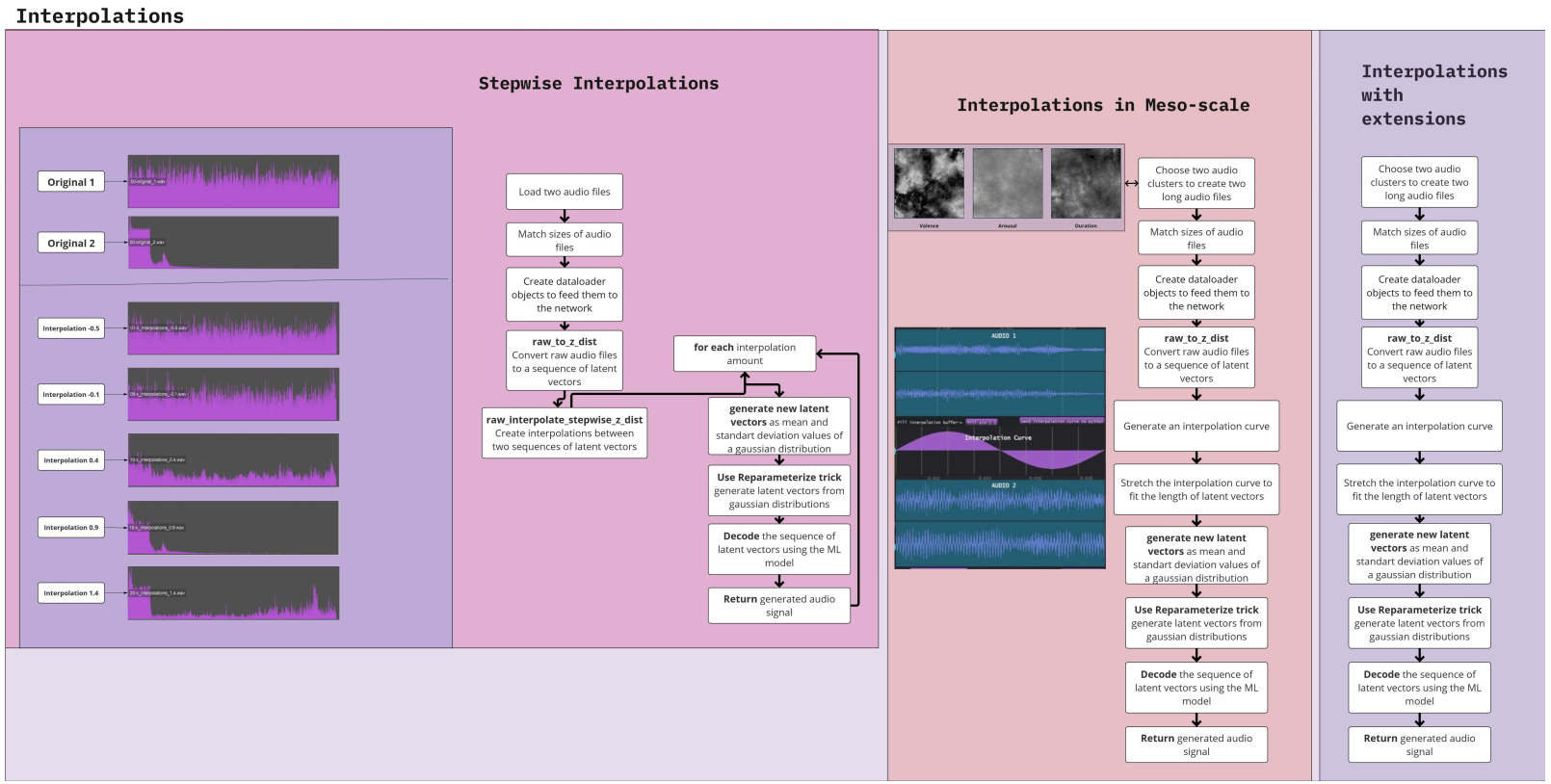
RawAudio Variational Autoencoder



K. Tatar, K. Cotton, and D. Bisig, “Sound Design Strategies for Latent Audio Space Explorations Using Deep Learning Architectures,” presented at the Proceedings of Sound and Music Computing 2023, 2023.

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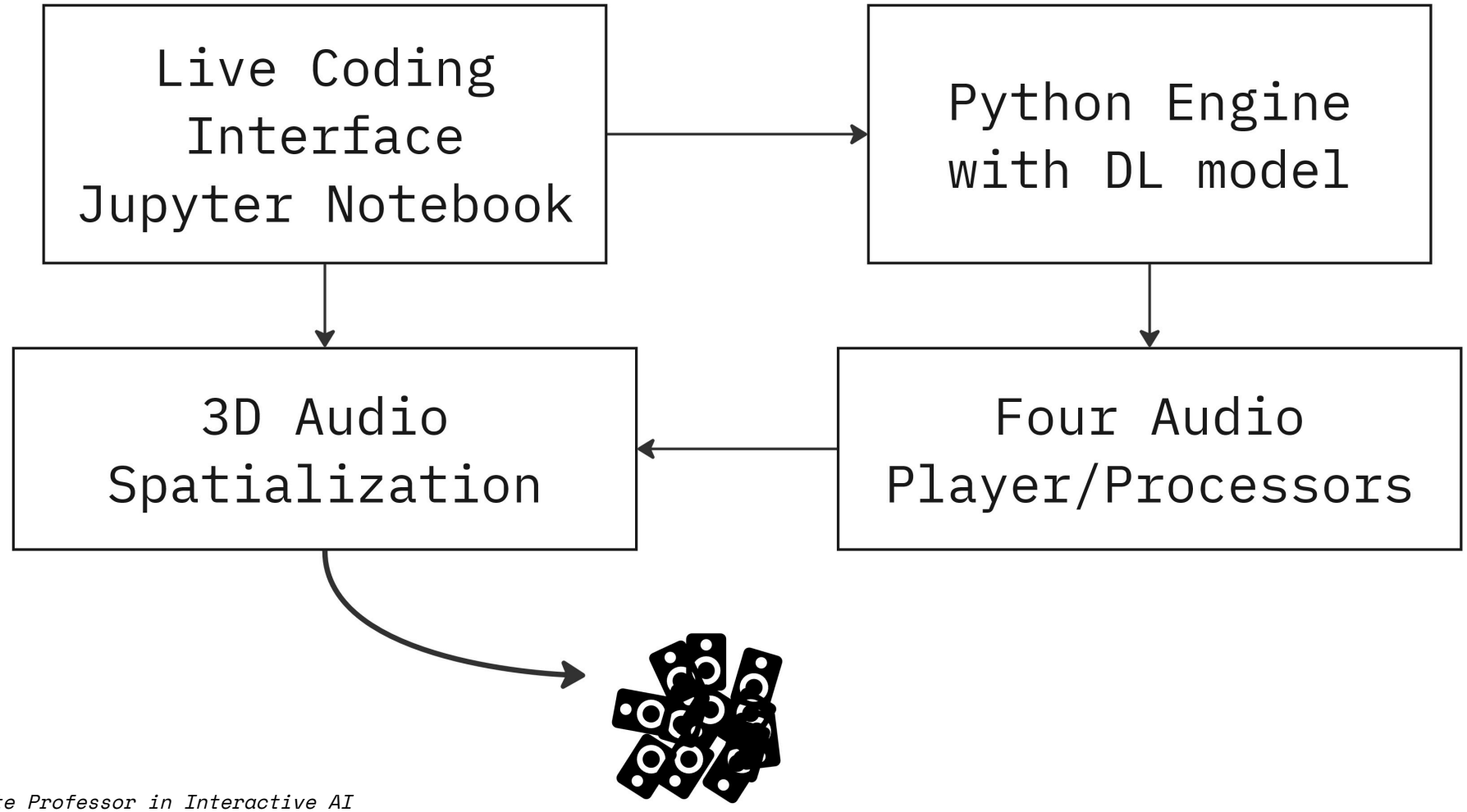

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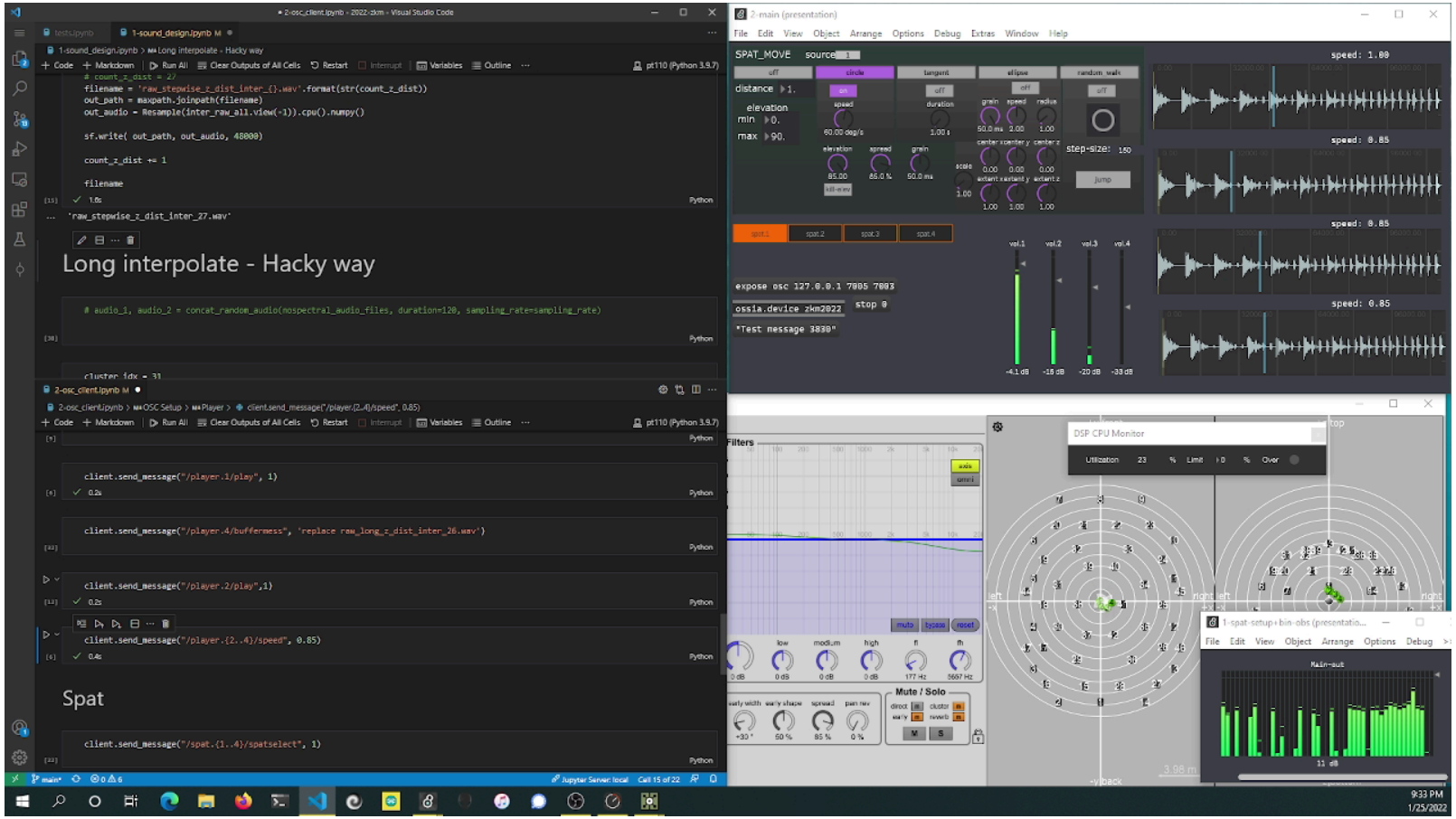
Coding the Latent



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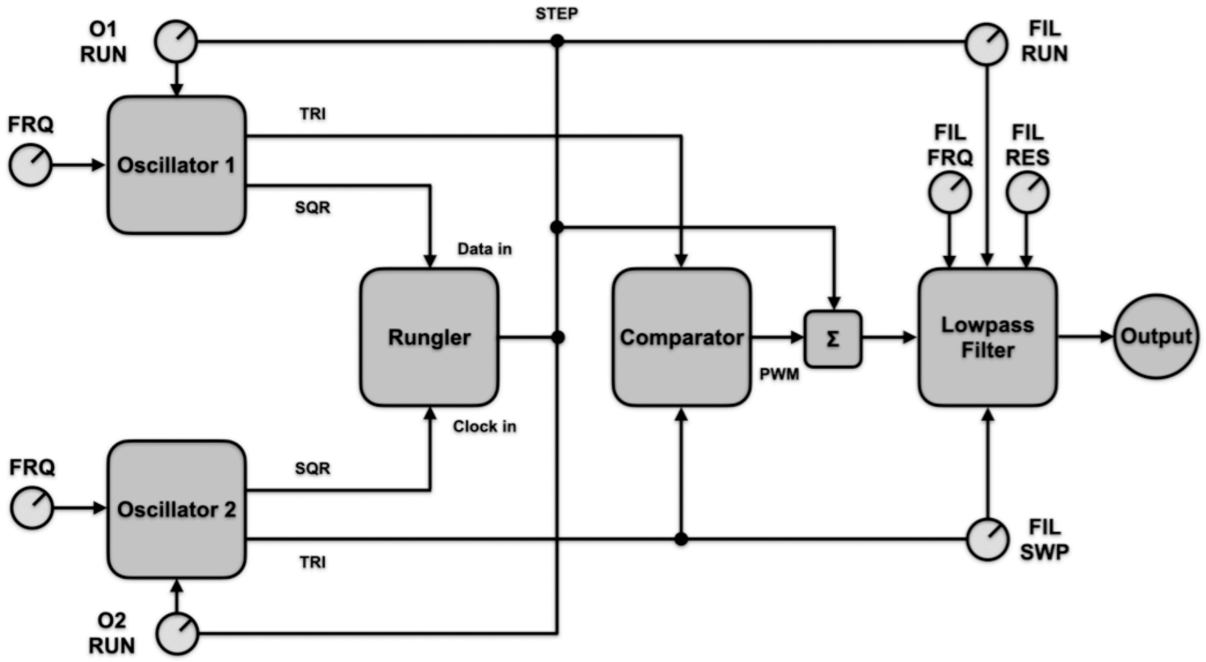
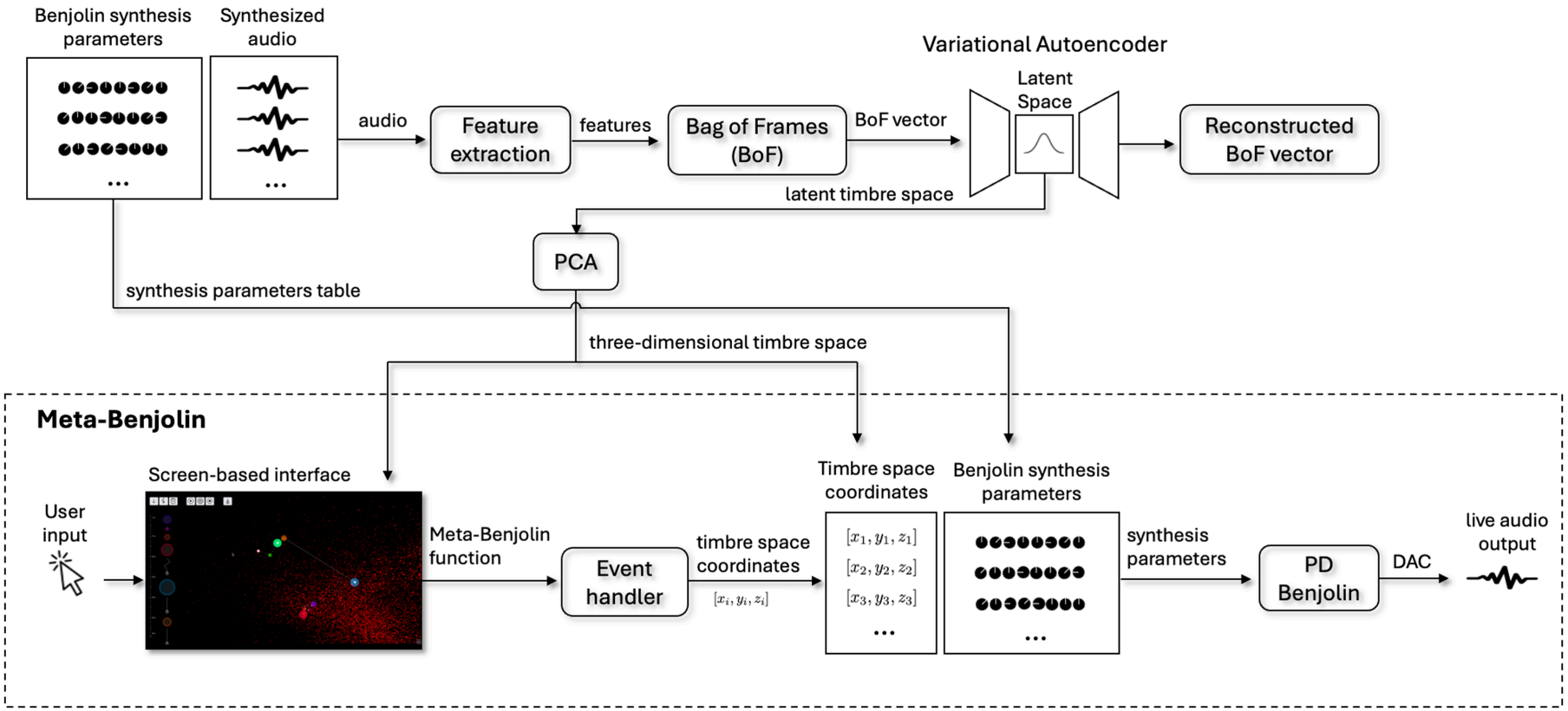
Music Notation and Composition with Latent Spaces (2026)

Meta-Benjolin



Madaghiele V., Lund L., Holzer D., Kelkar T., Tatar, K., and Holzapfel A. (2026). Expanding the machine: notating generative synthesis with a state-based representation and an interactive timbre space. Organised Sound, Cambridge Press.

Music Notation and Composition with Latent Spaces



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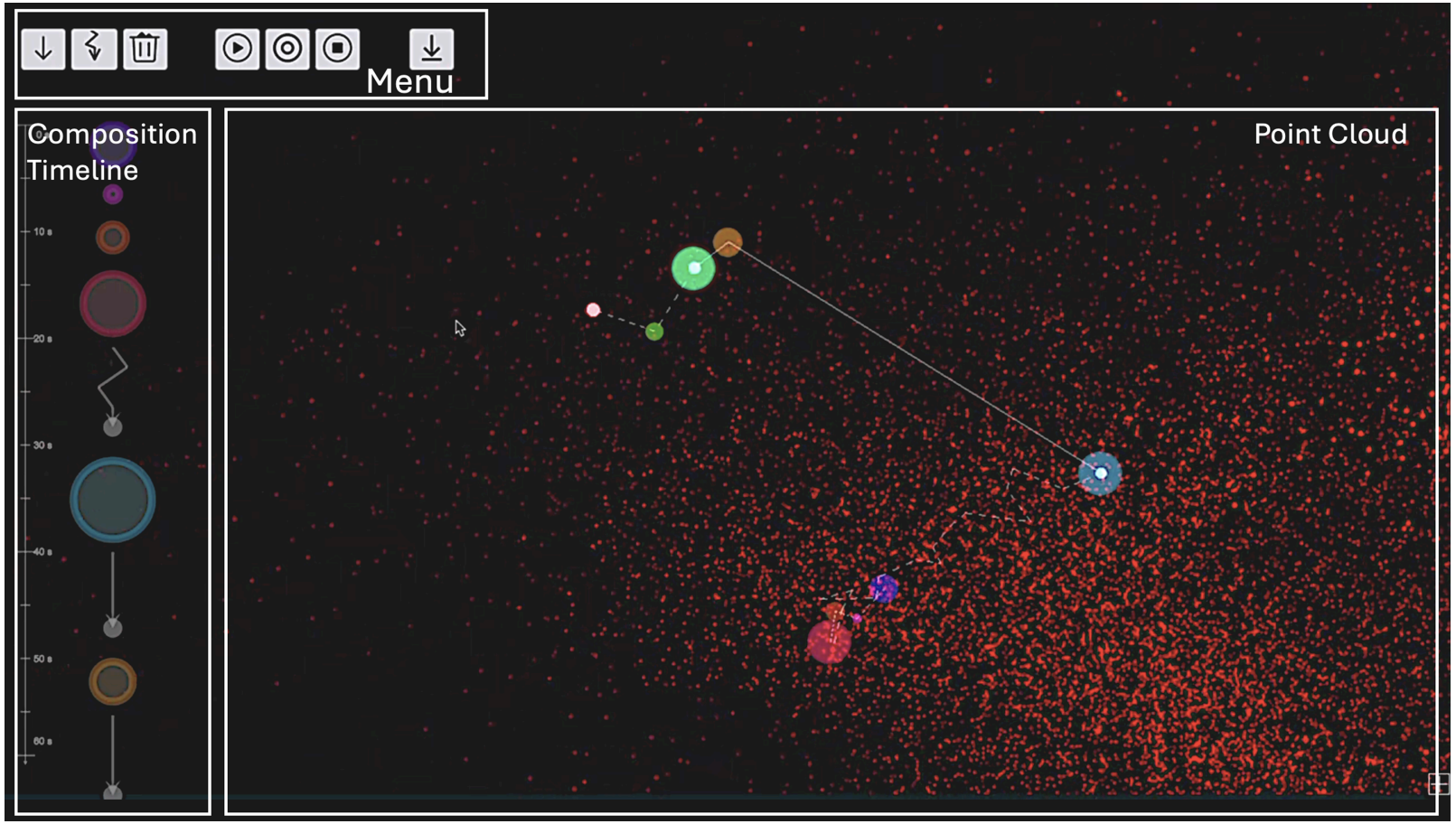
Music Notation and Composition with Latent Spaces



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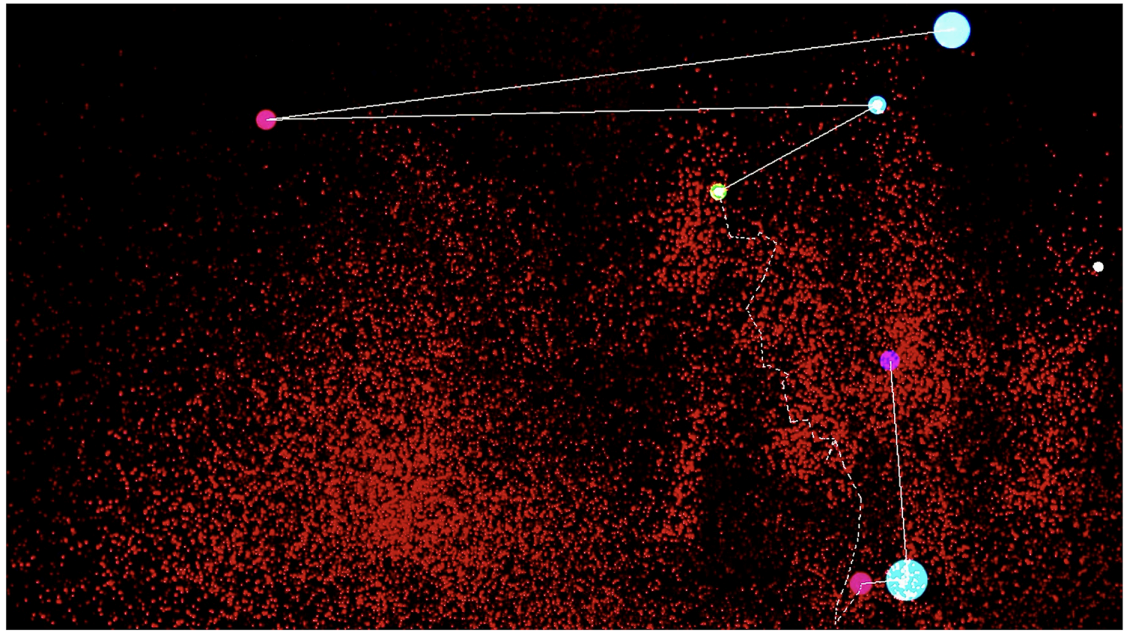
Music Notation and Composition with Latent Spaces

(a)



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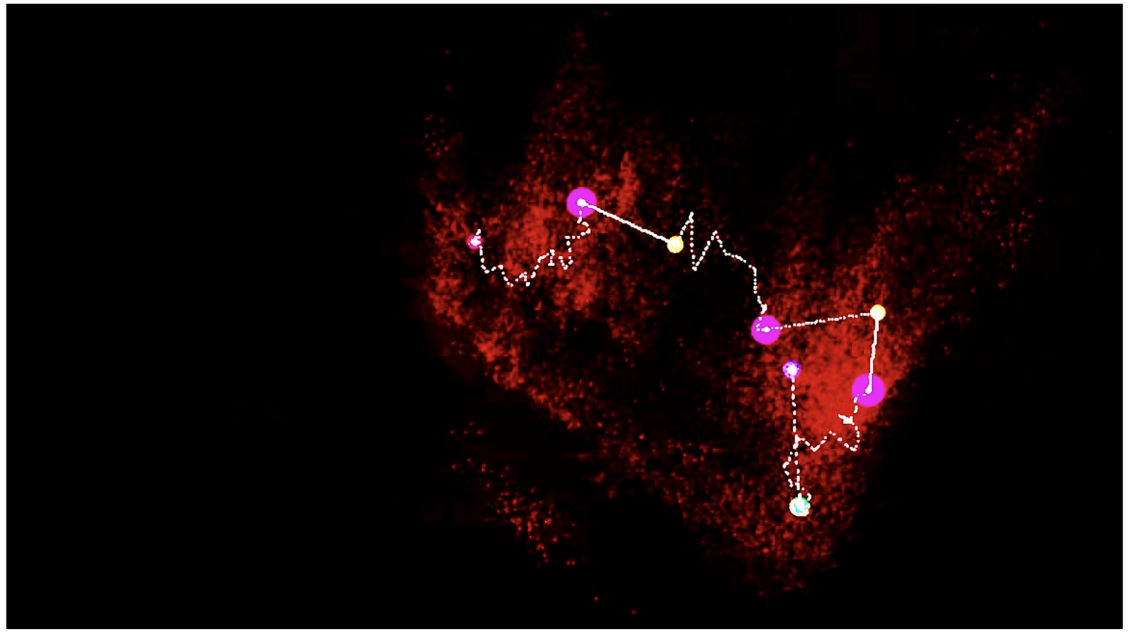

Examples of the use of transitions to navigate long distances. D2 used a meander transition in the middle of the piece to connect two sections; within a section, neighbouring states are connected using crossfades. A5 used a crossfade and a meander transition to navigate between two neighbourhoods in the cloud, each corresponding to a section in their piece. (a) Composition by D2 (detail), Sound_example_4.m4a in the sound material. (b) Composition by A5 (detail), Sound_example_5.m4a in the sound material.

Music Notation and Composition with Latent Spaces

https://meta-benjolin.com/

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Madaghiele V., Lund L., Holzer D., Kelkar T., Tatar, K., and Holzapfel A. (2026). Expanding the machine: notating generative synthesis with a state-based representation and an interactive timbre space. Organised Sound, Cambridge Press.

Deep Generative Modelling in Audiovisuals

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Expert Procrastinator's Tool: Artificial Intelligence (2023)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xdf1uKzGYfs

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AI Models in Expert Procrastinator's Tool: Artificial Intelligence

Text Generation: vicuna-13b on FastChat

Video Generation: Stable Diffusion 2.1 on automatic1111

Musical AI Frameworks:

- -Musical Agents based on Self-Organizing Maps, Tatar et al. 2019
- -Latent Vector Synthesis: Master thesis by David Högberg

What if we automate all aspects of an artwork creation?

What agency is left for the artist?

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While the creative processes, interaction, and technology affordances are different with highly automated AI technology, the human is much present in aesthetic choices and its decisions.

The agency is more concentrated in the familiarity, power, and control over the AI technology.

One type of first step in artistic technology research, is "what if?"

Another type is the curiosity towards a new and emerging technology

Digital Ripples (2020)

An exploration into VQGAN and NFTs.

Credits

Author	Role
Kıvanç Tatar	Video and Artistic Director
Paul Paroczai	Sound Design
Esra Ozkan	Curator
Nancy Lee	Curator
Lucy Strauss	Technical Specialist

Digital Ripples (2020)

```
<iframe src="https://objkt.com/tokens/hicetnunc/726715" title="AI
Dungeon" style=" position: absolute; inset: 0; width: 100%;
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Experiments with VQGAN Text-to-Image Synthesis (2021)

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: The Cyber Future

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=79gJtoeOhHE&source_ve_path=MTc4NDI0

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gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-
origin-when-cross-origin" allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: The Cyber Future

-AI Image Model: Stable Diffusion 2.1

-Clustering: Uniform Manifold Approximation and Projection

-Image prompt matrix is using two taxonomies:
Arvidson, 2009. A Gender Based Adjectival
Study of Women's and Men's Magazines
+
List of ethnicities in Labor force characteristics
by U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: The Machine Lexicon

https://youtu.be/5vgFnWk6rWs

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gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-
origin-when-cross-origin" allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: The Machine Lexicon

AI models used for,

- -text: chatgpt 5.3, chatgpt-4o-latest-20250326, Claude, deepseek-r1-0528, grok, llama-4-maverick-03-26-experimental, mistral-small-3.1-24b-instruct-2503
- -text-to-image:
  - -CLIP-ViT-g-14-laion2B-s12B-b42K
  - -Stable Diffusion:
    - -Model hash: e6bb9ea85b
    - -Model: sd_xl_base_1.0_0.9vae
    - -Refiner: sd_xl_refiner_1.0_0.9vae [8d0ce6c016]
      - -Refiner switch at: 0.8
      - -Version: v1.10.1
- -Clustering: Uniform Manifold Approximation and Projection

Performance setup for 2nd and 3rd editions

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: Digital Assemblage

https://youtu.be/cODIggxDDv4

```
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gyroscope; picture-in-picture; web-share" referrerpolicy="strict-
origin-when-cross-origin" allowfullscreen></iframe>
```

Exposing the Bias in Artificial Intelligence: Digital Assemblage

AI models used for,

-text: chatgpt 5.3, chatgpt-4o-latest-20250326, Claude, deepseek-r1-0528, grok, llama-4-maverick-03-26-experimental, mistral-small-3.1-24b-instruct-2503

-text-to-image:

-CLIP-ViT-g-14-laion2B-s12B-b42K

-Stable Diffusion:

-Model hash: e6bb9ea85b

-Model: sd_xl_base_1.0_0.9vae

-Refiner: sd_xl_refiner_1.0_0.9vae [8d0ce6c016]

-Refiner switch at: 0.8

-Version: v1.10.1

-Clustering: Uniform Manifold Approximation and Projection

-text-to-voice: Qwen3-TTS: Qwen/Qwen3-TTS-12Hz-1.7B-VoiceDesign

-talking head synthesis: Ditto: motion-space diffusion for controllable realtime talking head synthesis

Key takeaways from Exposing the Bias series

- Many of generative AI models shares the same underlying models for embeddings.
  - For example word2vec for word embeddings, CLIP for text-image embeddings
- We still do not know what societal values and associations are hidden in those models.

Towards Critical Computing in Artistic Technology Research

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Opportunities

-There are opportunities to lead new interdisciplinary research directions such as *artistic technology research*.

-We can cultivate the academic venues and communities where ML/AI research is truly conjointed.

-We should consider reforming arts and music education at all levels for the new AI era.

Challenges

-The confounding of research and science is a major challenge for ML/AI research in Arts and Music.

-As ML/AI research has become less and less inviting to interdisciplinarity, the music and arts knowledge has been less present in this domain.

-There is very few direct educational paths to become an expert in ML/AI in Arts and Music.

The details of ML/AI algorithms matter in conceptualizing artistic works involving them.

Takeaways

- There are much more exciting venues to explore with technology other than problem solving and optimization.
- We are missing research methods and theoretical foundations to research aesthetic affordances and experiences of Artificial Intelligence.
- Most AI/ML efforts in arts and music are ad-hoc, and shared understanding requires better epistemic foundations.
- Artificial Intelligence is a collection of different type of algorithms, not just LLMs. Each have their own specifics.

Thank you!

Feel free to reach out -> kivanc.tatar@uniarts.fi

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Appendixes

Appendix: Societal Impact of AI in Culture, Arts, and Music

Societal Impact of AI in Culture, Arts, and Music

- **A Shift in Artistic Practices through Artificial Intelligence**
- Caring Trouble and Musical AI
- Bringing the Body Back to AI Voice and Speech Technologies

A Shift in Artistic Practices through Artificial Intelligence

Labor in Artistic Data

Infinite Content on the Boundless Internet

Datasets through Internet Scraping

Easily accessible content generators

James Gurney mentions

> "I think it is only fair to people looking at this work that they should know what the prompt was and also what software was used. I think the artists should be allowed to opt-in or opt-out of having their work that they worked so hard on by hand be used as a dataset for creating this other artwork."

Shifts in Artistic Practices

Expansion of Actors involved

New Markets and Economy of Arts and Music

Shifts if Stakeholders and Gatekeepers

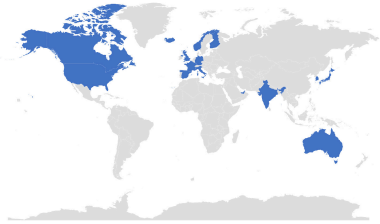
Sustainability, Ethics, Accessibility, and Inclusion

Consent, tracebility, regulations, and accountability

Legal discussions such as copyright

Unequal power in big tech

Countries with AI guidelines



K. Tatar et al., "A Shift in Artistic Practices through Artificial Intelligence," Leonardo, pp. 293–297, Apr. 2024, doi: 10.1162/leon_a_02523.

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Societal Impact of AI in Culture, Arts, and Music

- A Shift in Artistic Practices through Artificial Intelligence
- **Caring Trouble and Musical AI**
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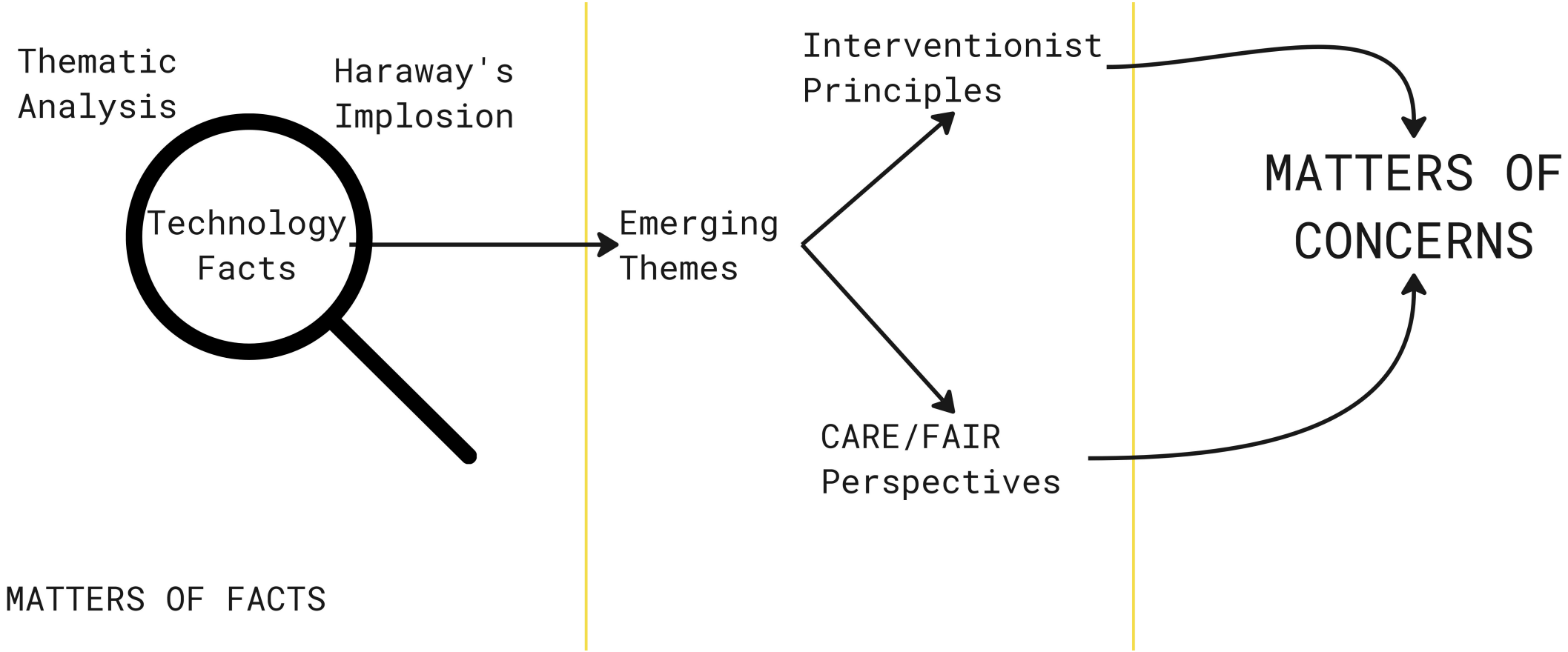

Thematic Analysis
Haraway's Implosion
Technology Facts
Emerging Themes
Interventionist Principles
CARE/FAIR Perspectives
MATTERS OF CONCERNS
MATTERS OF FACTS

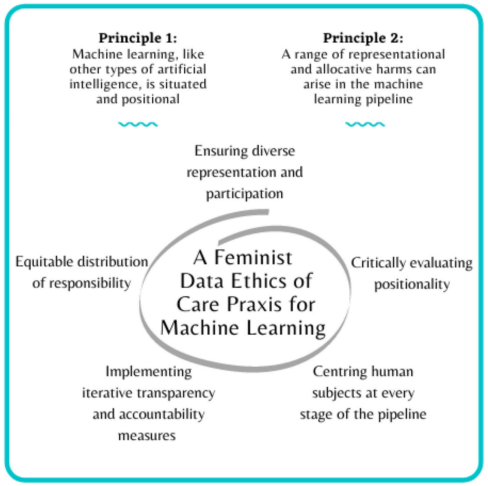
Caring Trouble and Musical AI

Implosion Dimensions

- Labour
- Professional/ Epistemological
- Material
- Technological
- Context and Situatedness
- Political
- Economic
- Textual
- Bodily/Organic
- Historical
- Particle
- Mythological
- Symbolic

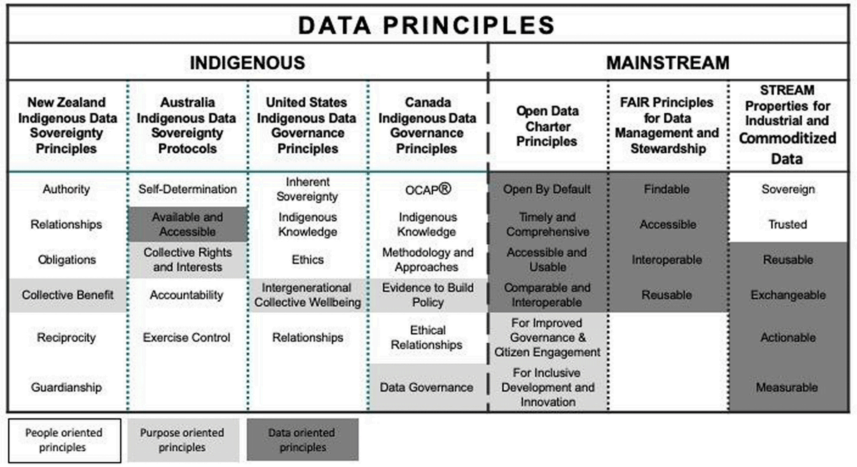
Dumit, J. (2014). Writing the Implosion: Teaching the World One Thing at a Time. Cultural Anthropology, 29(2), 344–362. https://doi.org/10.14506/ca29.2.09

Interventionist Principles



Gray, J., & Witt, A. (2021). A feminist data ethics of care for machine learning: The what, why, who and how. First Monday. https://doi.org/10.5210/fm.v26i12.11833

CARE/FAIR Perspectives



Carroll, S., Garba, I., Figueroa-Rodríguez, O., Holbrook, J., Lovett, R., Materechera, S., … Hudson, M. (2020). The CARE Principles for Indigenous Data Governance. Data Science Journal, (19), 1–12. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.5334/dsj-2020-043

Haraway, D. (2013). A cyborg manifesto: Science, technology, and socialist-feminism in the late twentieth century. In The transgender studies reader (pp. 103–118). Routledge.

Societal Impact of AI in Culture, Arts, and Music

-A Shift in Artistic Practices through Artificial Intelligence

-Caring Trouble and Musical AI

-**Bringing the Body Back to AI Voice and Speech Technologies**

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Bringing the Body Back to AI Voice and Speech Technologies

Susan Bennett and Jon Briggs provided voice recordings for GM Voices, which were later licensed to ScanSoft.

Their voice datasets were then later allegedly used to build the voice of the American Siri (Bennett) and British Siri (Briggs) through speech concatenation.

Apple has never confirmed, nor denied whether they utilised Bennett's concatenated speech data, nor Briggs'. In the case of Bennett, audio forensics expert Ed Primeau studied recordings of Siri and blind recordings of Bennett's voice and presented his the conclusion of his analysis that "They are identical – a 100 % match."

Cotton, Kelsey, de Vries, Katja & Tatar, Kıvanç. (2024). Singing for the Missing: Bringing the Body Back to AI Voice and Speech Technologies. In Proceedings of the 9th International Conference on Movement and Computing. Utrecht, Netherlands, May 2024. https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3658852.3659065

Bringing the Body Back to AI Voice and Speech Technologies

-Integrating voice rights into personality rights frameworks

-The data frameworks for voice should be designed to have direct connection to their source body

-Similarity should be revisited, where nations take their own stances through democratic processes

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Appendix: AI in Computational Creativity and Game Design

AI in Computational Creativity and Game Design

-Towards Computationally Creative Game Design

-LLM-Based Executable Synthesis of Goal Playable Game Design Patterns

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AI in Computational Creativity and Game Design

- **Towards Computationally Creative Game Design**
- LLM-Based Executable Synthesis of Goal Playable Game Design Patterns

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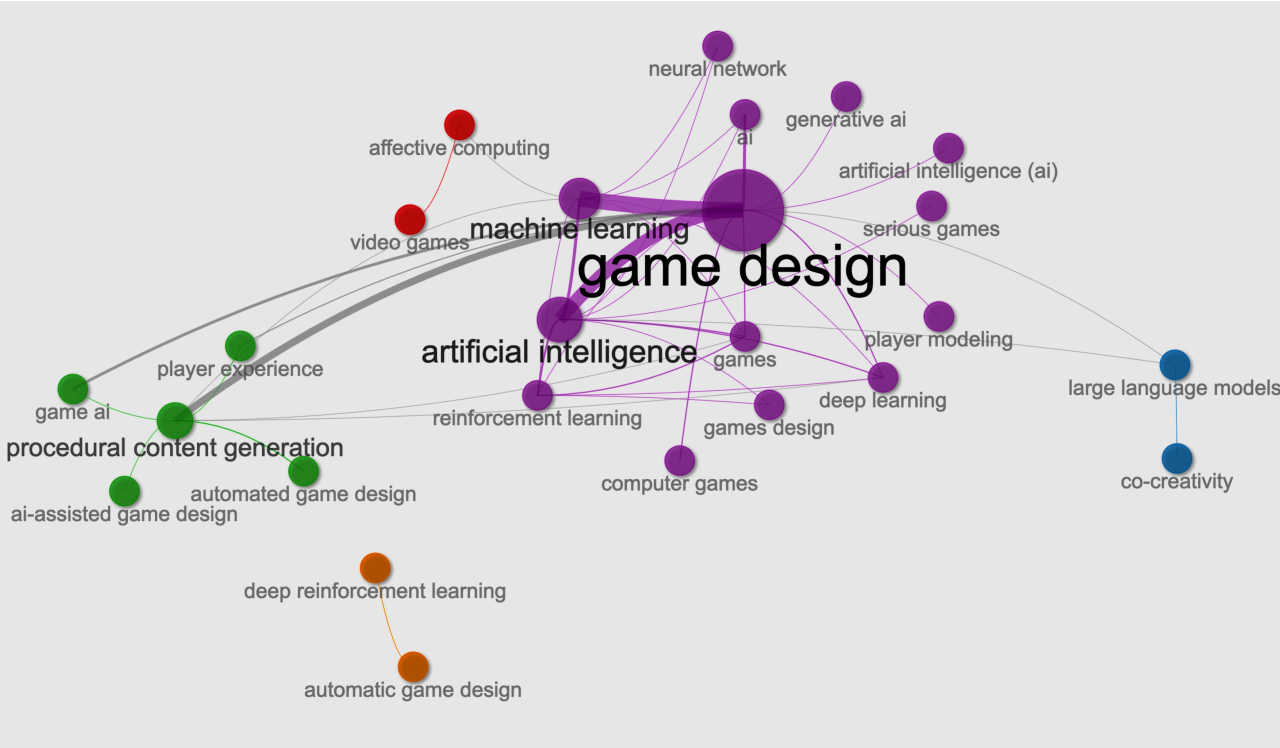
Towards Computationally Creative Game Design

Reviewed 236 studies on learning-based AI in game design

While AI technologies are widely applied for functional and procedural tasks, **creativity remains underexplored**

We investigated the correlation between the appearance of creativity-related terms and their co-occurrence with other keywords.

The co-occurrence network here visualizes the relationships and connections between frequently co-occurring keywords within the same article.



Liu, H. X., Cotton, K., Björk, S., Tatar, K. Towards Computationally Creative Game Design in Human-Computer Interaction: A Systematic Overview of Learning-based Artificial Intelligence in Game Design. Submitted to Games: Research and Practice.

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Previous work

Game Design Patterns (Bjork and Holopainen, 2005) includes 200 patterns.

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http://virt10.itu.chalmers.se/index.php/Category:Patterns

Bjork, S., and Holopainen, J. 2005. Patterns in game design, volume 11. Charles River Media Hingham.

AI in Computational Creativity and Game Design

- Towards Computationally Creative Game Design
- **LLM-Based Executable Synthesis of Goal Playable Game Design Patterns**

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LLM-Based Executable Synthesis of Goal Playable Game Design Patterns

We investigated whether large language models can translate structured game-design knowledge—specifically goal-pattern abstractions—into executable Unity game scenes

Game Development Framing: Digital game development as a computational creativity activity, in which design-pattern abstractions and game engine constraints guide the creation of an executable, playable game

Execution-grounded evaluation pipeline: An end-to-end workflow (LLM generation → Unity batch compilation → log-based failure analysis) for assessing executable viability at scale.

Insights on human–machine knowledge boundaries: Game design pattern knowledge injection increases structural complexity requirement at generation, revealing a tension in how domain knowledge should be injected into generative systems.

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Grounding Machine Creativity in Game Design Knowledge Representations

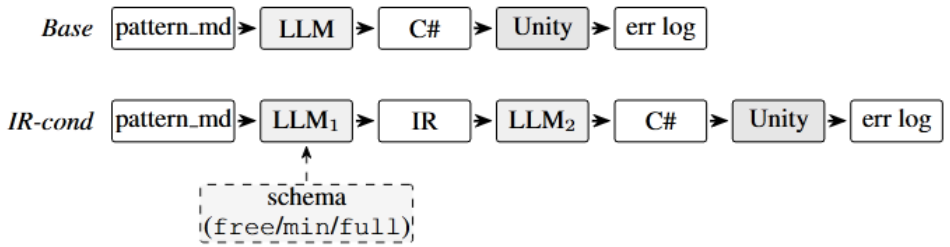

Figure 1: Baseline and IR-conditioned pipelines. Data (white), LLM (light grey), compile target (dark grey), schema injection (dashed). Both share the same Unity batch-replay harness and error-log aggregation.

Liu, H. X., & Tatar, K. (2026). Grounding Machine Creativity in Game Design Knowledge Representations: Empirical Probing of LLM-Based Executable Synthesis of Goal Playable Patterns under Structural Constraints. arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.07101.

Mage: Multi-Axis Evaluation of LLM-Generated Executable Game Scenes Beyond Compile-Pass Rate

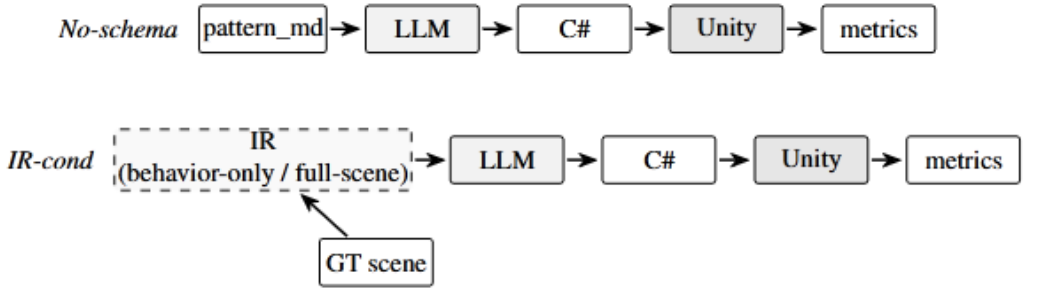

Figure 1: Two evaluation conditions. *No-schema*: the LLM receives only the natural-language pattern description. *IR-cond*: the LLM receives a ground-truth-derived IR at one of two granularity levels (behavior-only or full-scene), extracted offline from the corresponding Unity scene by an automated pipeline (Section 3.3); the natural-language description is not provided. Both conditions feed into the same Unity batch-replay harness for metric collection. Box shading: data (white), LLM (light grey), runtime artifact (dark grey), schema (dashed).

Liu, H. X., & Tatar, K. (2026). Mage: Multi-Axis Evaluation of LLM-Generated Executable Game Scenes Beyond Compile-Pass Rate. Submitted to NeurIPS 2026. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.07342.

Mage: Multi-Axis Evaluation of LLM-Generated Executable Game Scenes Beyond Compile-Pass Rate

Table 2: Compile and runtime success rates per model and IR condition. C = compile success; R = runtime success. Counts in parentheses; runtime success is a strict subset of compile success. Qwen2.5 × full-scene is excluded due to 32K context overflow.

	No-schema		Behavior-only		Full-scene	
	C	R	C	R	C	R
Qwen3-30B	83% (65)	**80% (63)**	42% (33)	37% (29)	47% (37)	42% (33)
Qwen2.5-7B	74% (58)	39% (31)	3% (3)	3% (3)	-	-
DeepSeek-16B	23% (18)	18% (14)	29% (23)	16% (13)	42% (33)	21% (17)
Gemma-4-26B	34% (27)	34% (27)	1% (1)	1% (1)	0% (0)	0% (0)
Mean	54%	43%	19%	14%	29%	21%

Table 5: Top 10 compile-error codes across the 858 evaluation attempts. NS = no-schema, BO = behavior-only, FS = full-scene.

Code	Meaning	Total	NS	BO	FS
CS0122	Inaccessible due to protection level	991	12	862	117
CS0029	Cannot implicitly convert type	730	219	291	220
CS0136	Local variable name conflict (scope)	504	150	126	228
CS1061	Type does not contain definition	495	102	151	242
CS0246	Type/namespace name not found	469	0	320	149
CS0117	Type does not contain definition (field)	435	93	192	150
CS0103	Name does not exist in context	383	33	272	78
CS1503	Cannot convert argument type	283	63	106	114
CS0176	Static member via instance reference	93	0	87	6
CS0120	Non-static field via type reference	60	54	0	6

AI in Computational Creativity and Game Design

-Compile rate alone as a misleading evaluation signal.

-A three-factor interpretation, anchored in the error taxonomy.

1- **Domain Completeness:** what information the intermediate representation carries

2- **API-mapping adequacy:** whether the prompt translates intermediate representation entity names into valid Unity API calls.

3- **LLM execution fidelity:** whether the model uses the information correctly

Any LLM code-generation task targeting a domain-specific framework faces these three factors.